

PASHA GADEMAN AND THE PURSUIT OF THE NEXT 'SPORTING HIGH' IN HOCKEY

Currently the head coach of one of the semifinalists in HIL, **Hyderabad Toofans**, Pasha Gademan has previously worked with the German men's team during its triumphant campaign at the World Cup in 2023.

Aashin Prasad
aashin.prasad@thehindu.co.in

"You could say I'm addicted to it [sports]. You start consuming it at a young age, more and more, and at some point, it's like you need it. Then, you're at the point where you can't live without it anymore," Pasha Gademan philosophically reflects when asked about what lies ahead for him.

For the Dutchman, it has been quite a journey — from Iran to India, where he is the head coach of Hyderabad Toofans, one of the semifinalists in the Hockey India League.

Along the way, he has experienced high points, such as the World Cup victory with Germany as an assistant coach, leading Rot-Weiss to Bundesliga championships, and coaching Canada at the Olympics — all by age 32. Gademan's pursuit of this passion began when he was six years old in Almere, the Netherlands, where his

parents had immigrated.

Almere is the youngest city in the Netherlands, established in 1975 to alleviate overcrowding in nearby Amsterdam, with over 200,000 people living on land that was once covered by the waters of the IJsselmeer. The Almere Hockey Club was founded in 1979, three years after the first house was built in the city.

Gademan and his family had no previous connection to the sport but stumbled upon the club while searching for a football team for his brother. "We had no history with the sport at all, but we became